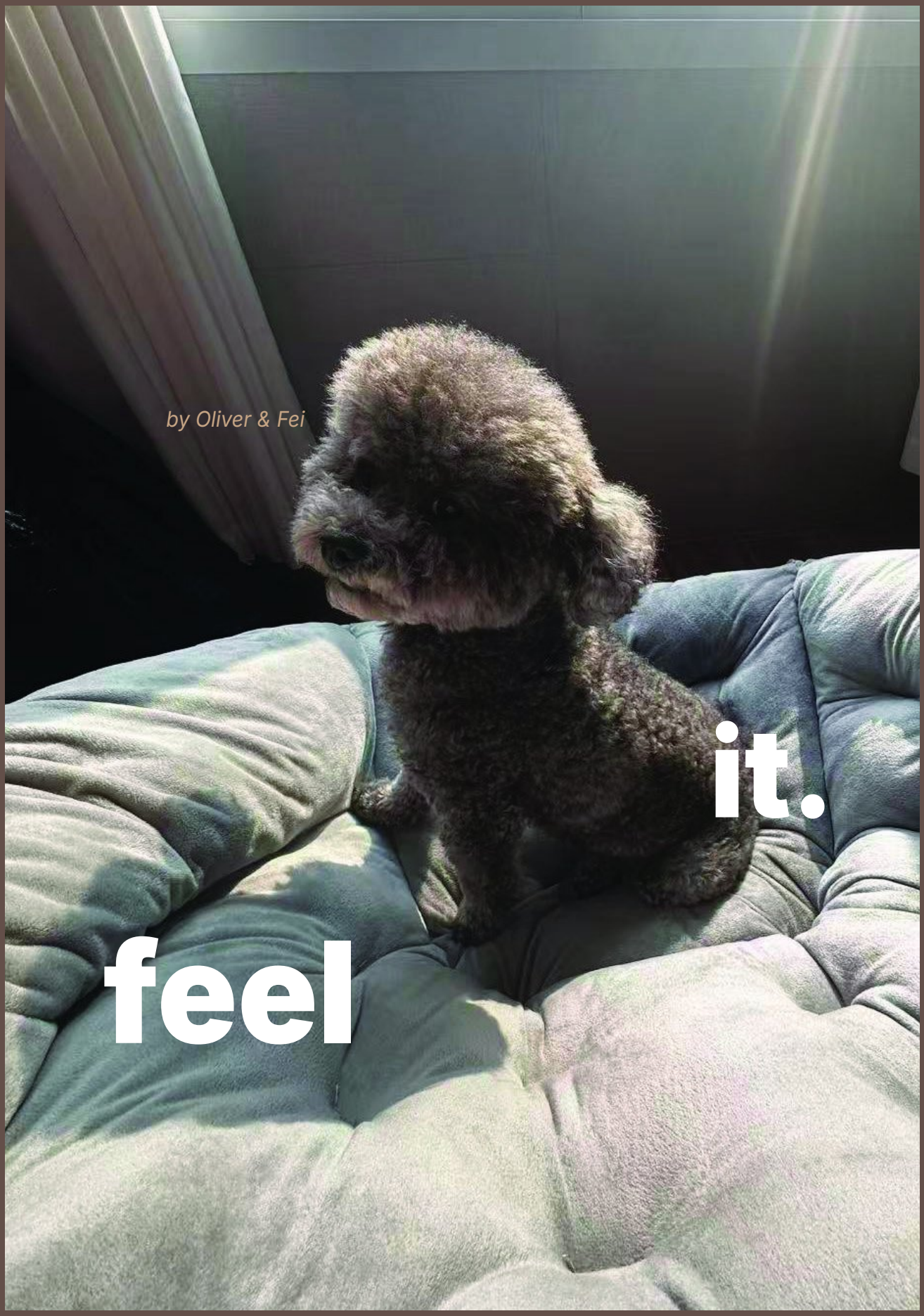
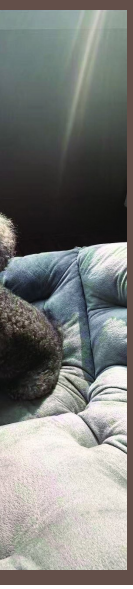
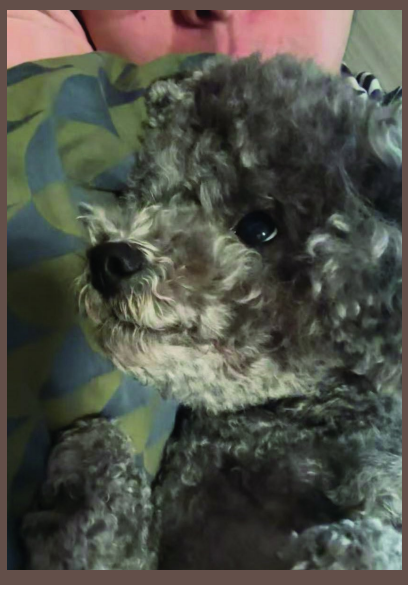
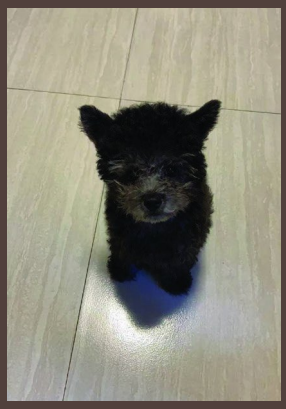

by Oliver & Fei
feel
it.

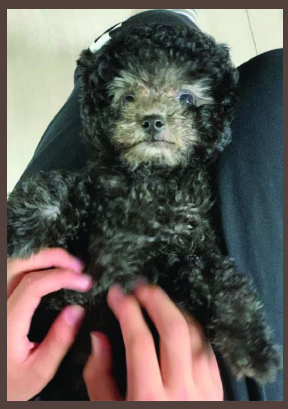
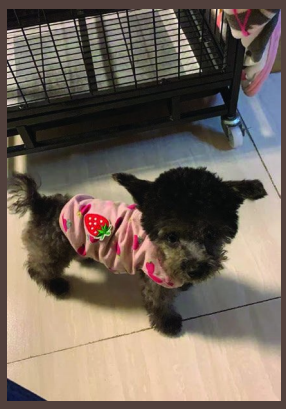
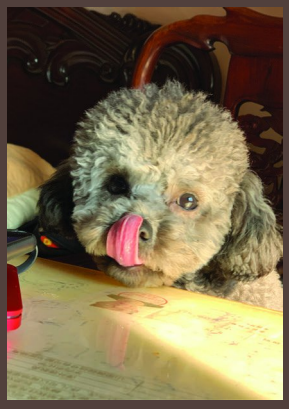
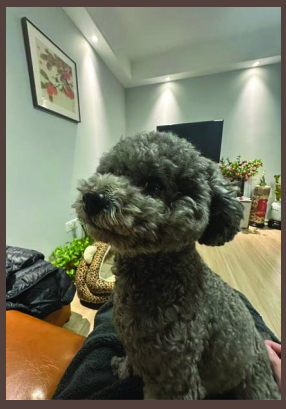
His Name is *Fei*

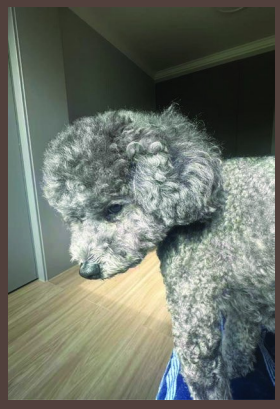
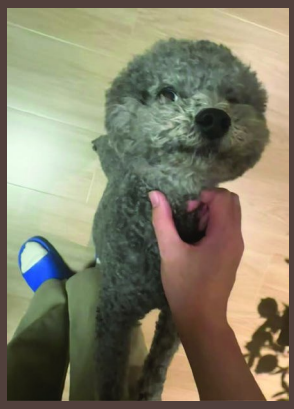
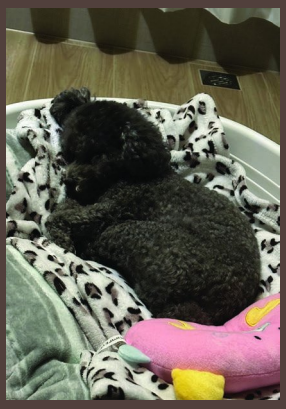



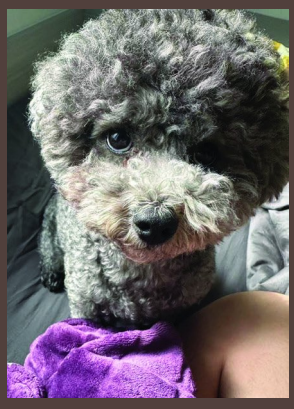
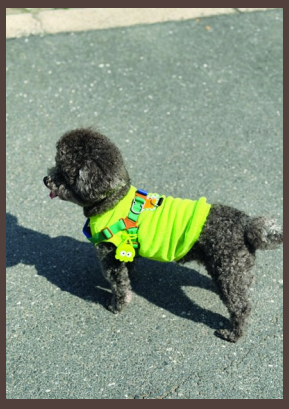

He's a quiet little pup.
Sometimes he may bark
fiercely at others,
but whenever I'm around,
he's always such a good boy.

He is a perfect
service provider :
an emotional support friend,
a cosy bedmate,
a bottomless eater,
and a 'carefreer',
...




It's our 7th year.



However...

Not everyone gets to enjoy the services Fei provides.
Sometimes he wrecks their clothes, barks furiously at them, bares his sharp little teeth... they end up with a sense of ***unease*** *(even* ***dislike****) towards Fei, and sometimes towards other dogs, too.*

It is not the fault of those "users", because they've genuinely been on the receiving end of Fei's poor treatment.

Personally, it is not Fei's fault either becasue the experience I've had is the complete opposite of theirs.

So, I wonder:
is there a way to help others break through this?



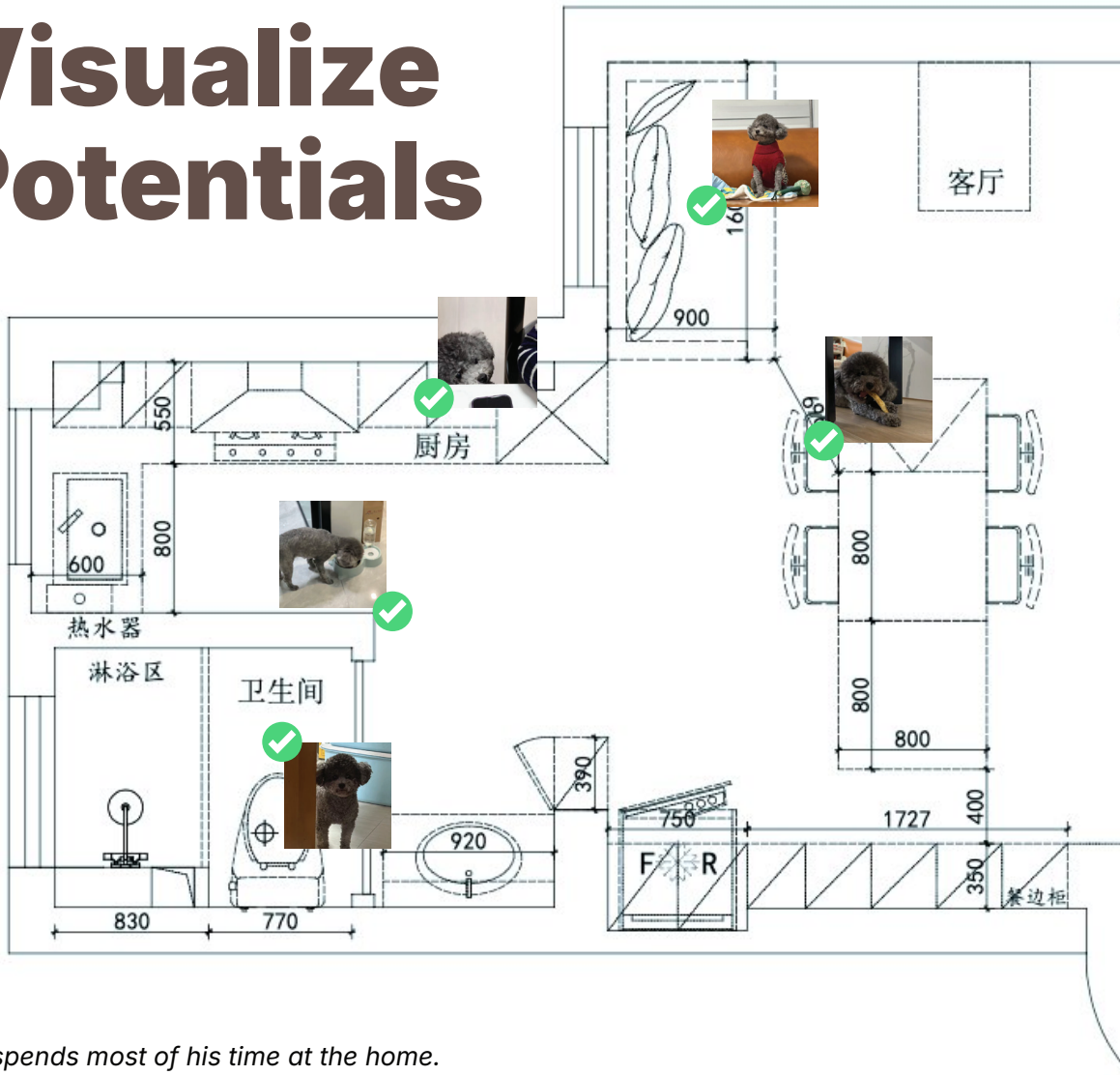


Brainstorming...



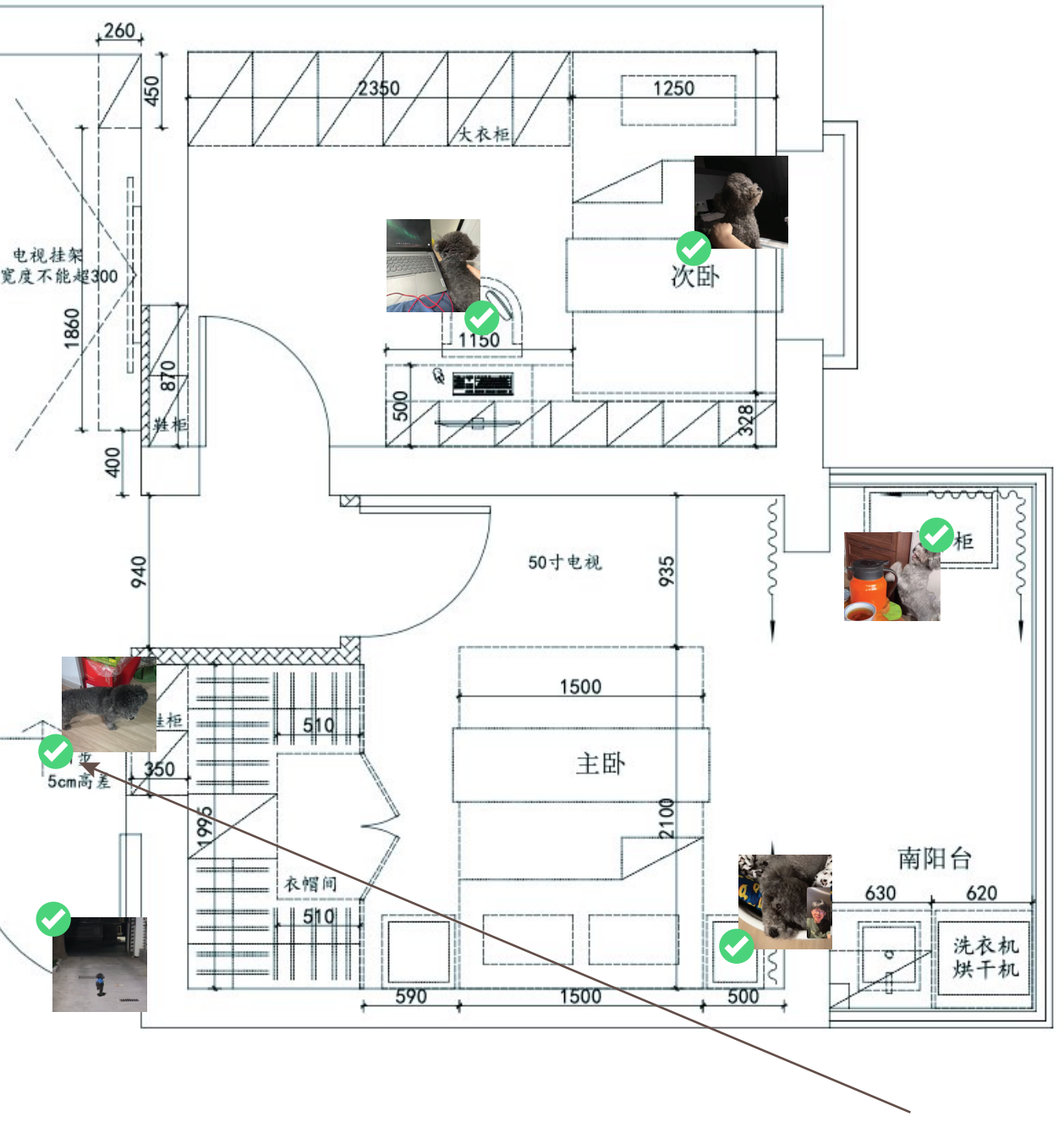
Design Opportunity

Visualize Potentials



Fei spends most of his time at the home.
If I can map out the exact journey of my experience with him,
and compare it with what the other users are ***missing or feeling bad****.*
"then would that be the way to solve this?"

The place I interact with Fei.

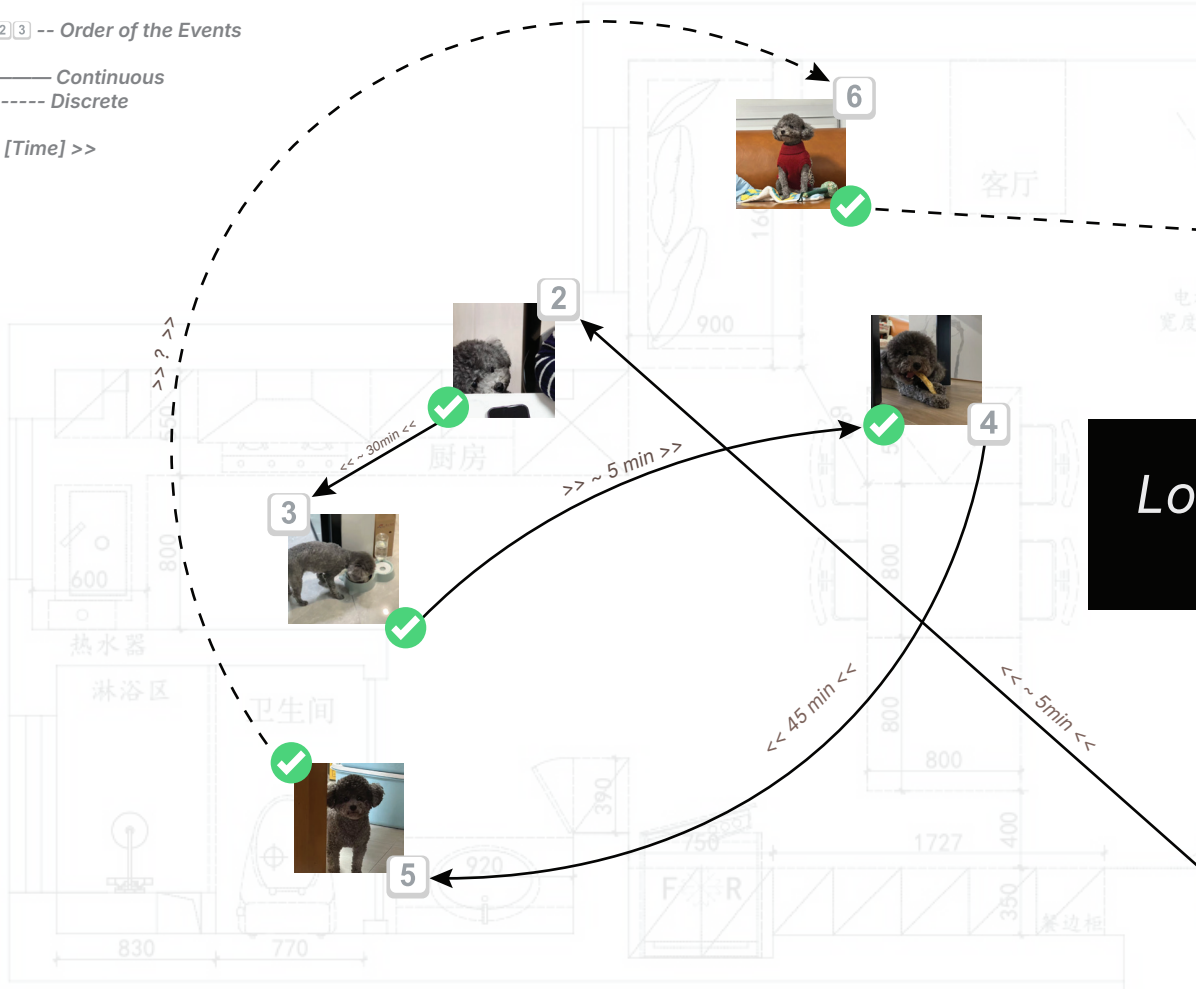


*It looks like the journey of this experience has to begin right at the **door**...*
*And who are those '**Alternative Users**' ?*

1 2 3 -- *Order of the Events*

——— *Continuous*
-------- *Discrete*

>> [Time] >>

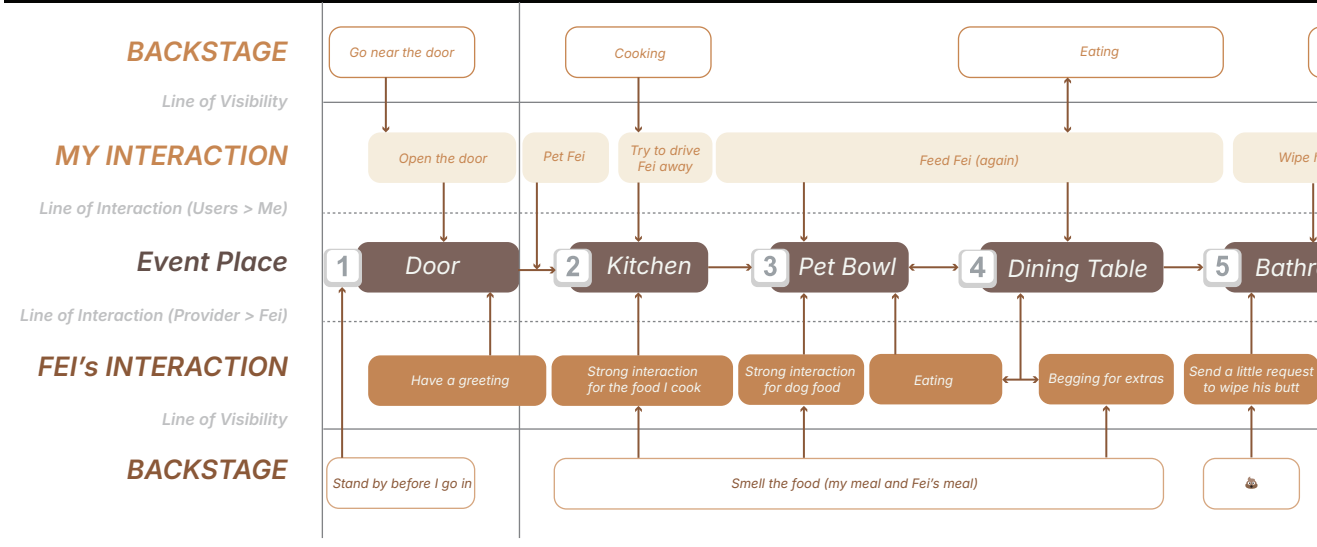


Possible Process

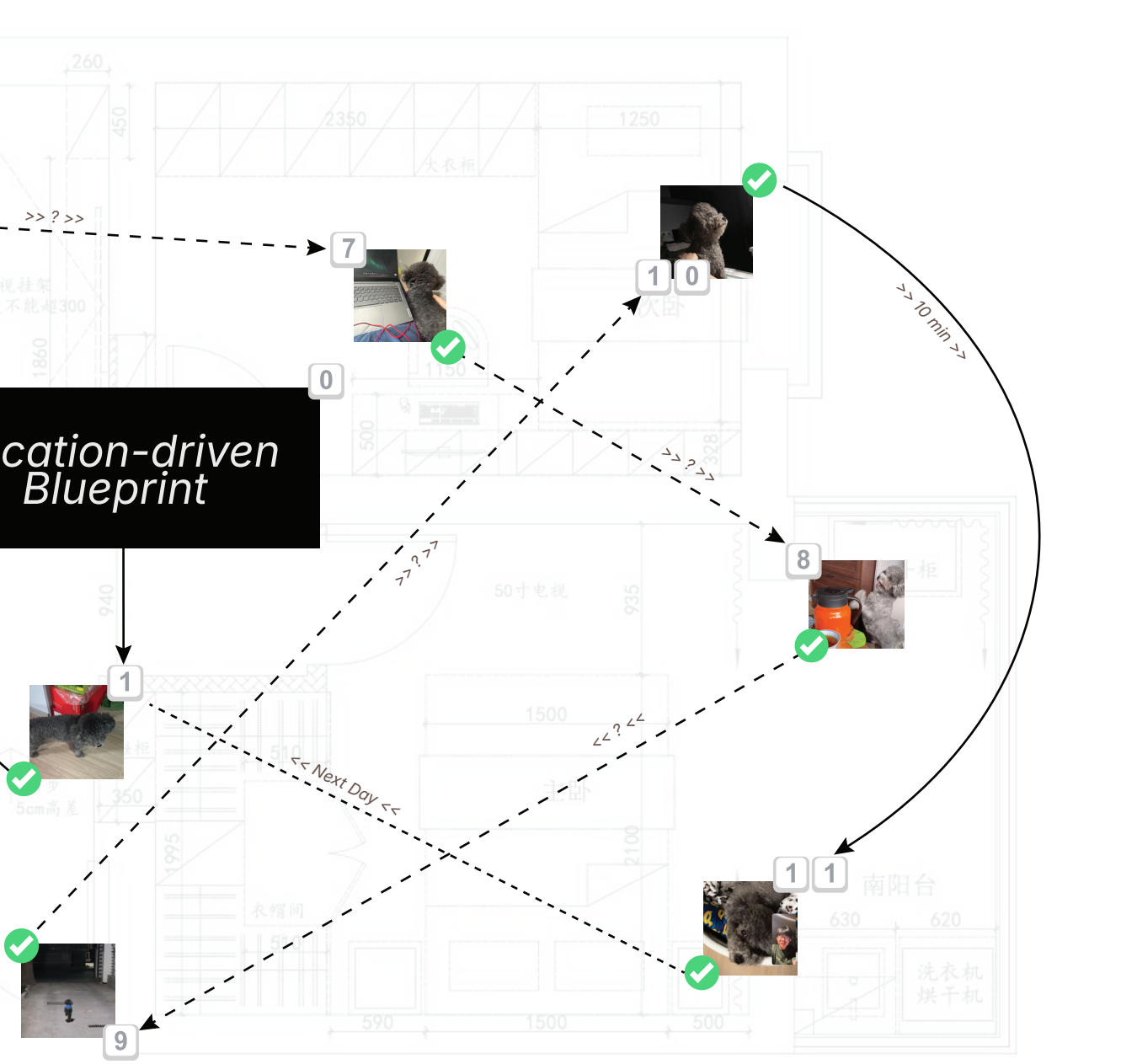
I can form a basic (not all continuous) route/process at the home and there are events/activities with Fei I notice clearly,

To brainstorm, I visualized these into two parts:
Location-driven & Event-driven

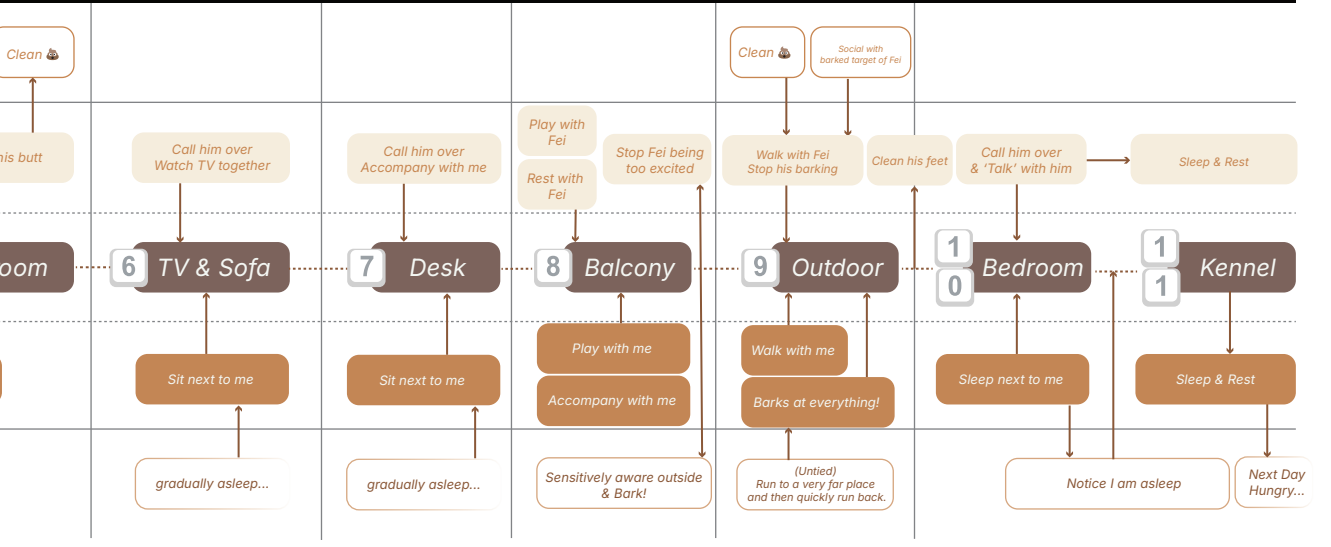
Event-drive



cation-driven Blueprint



en Blueprint



From location-driven:

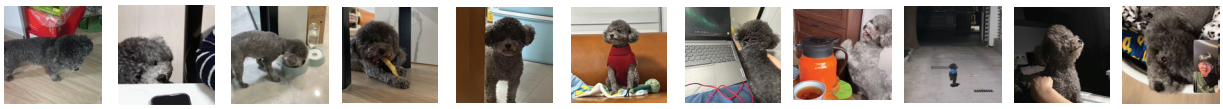
Alternative Users

*For other users, those experiences are entirely **frequent/random/messy** from the moment they step through the door. They are confused; they need **time**. It reminds me of when I first brought Fei home: I was just as lost and unsure back then, and it took a long, steady **effort** to get to where we are now.*

For alternative users, they could be those who long to know Fei but are too afraid to approach, or who want a dog as a pet but are scared of dogs.

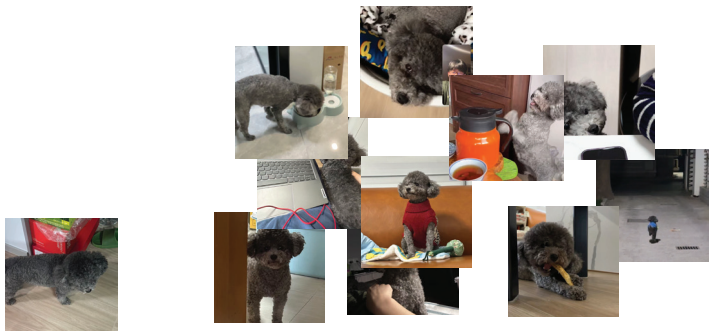
Thus, the first experience maybe very important...

Me:

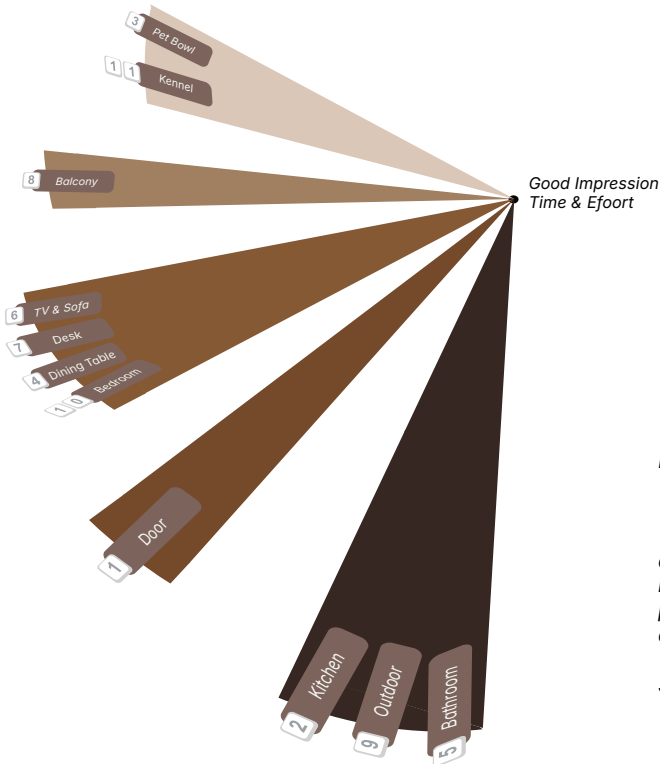


Enter ---------- *Leave*

Others:



Enter ---------- *Leave*



From event-driven:

Design Opportunity

Down SLOPY *Up*

*But to receive Fei's services, it seems a user must first '**cost**' something — through action, through experience.*

*Yet each of these "experiences" comes with its own difficulty: some services are very hard to get a '**benefit**' in a short time, like climbing a steep hill, demanding long, patient effort. Other experiences, however, are easily accessed, as simple as walking downhill.*

So...

Easier



*# enjoy **benefits** at beginning*

*# Out of sight, out of **cost***

Virtual

The first experience could be [more] ...



Can try multiple times.

Cute!

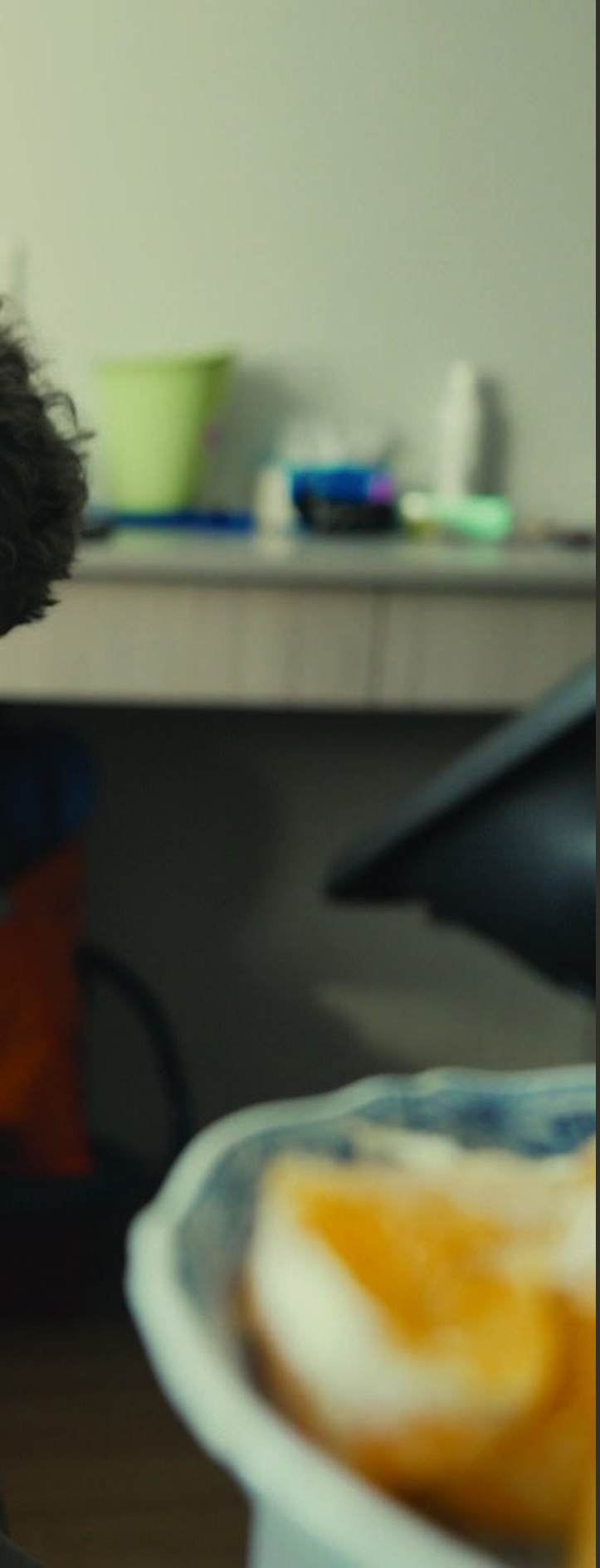
Tolerable







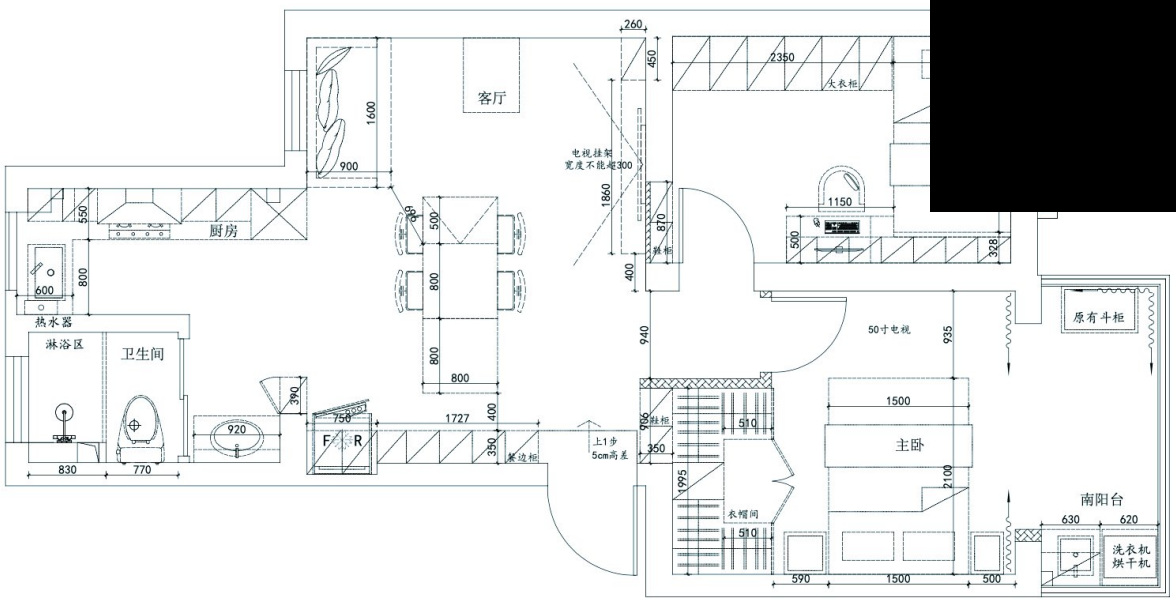
So… why not make all these into a 2D game (simulator) ?
Guiding the audience to do things that are more beneficial than costly.



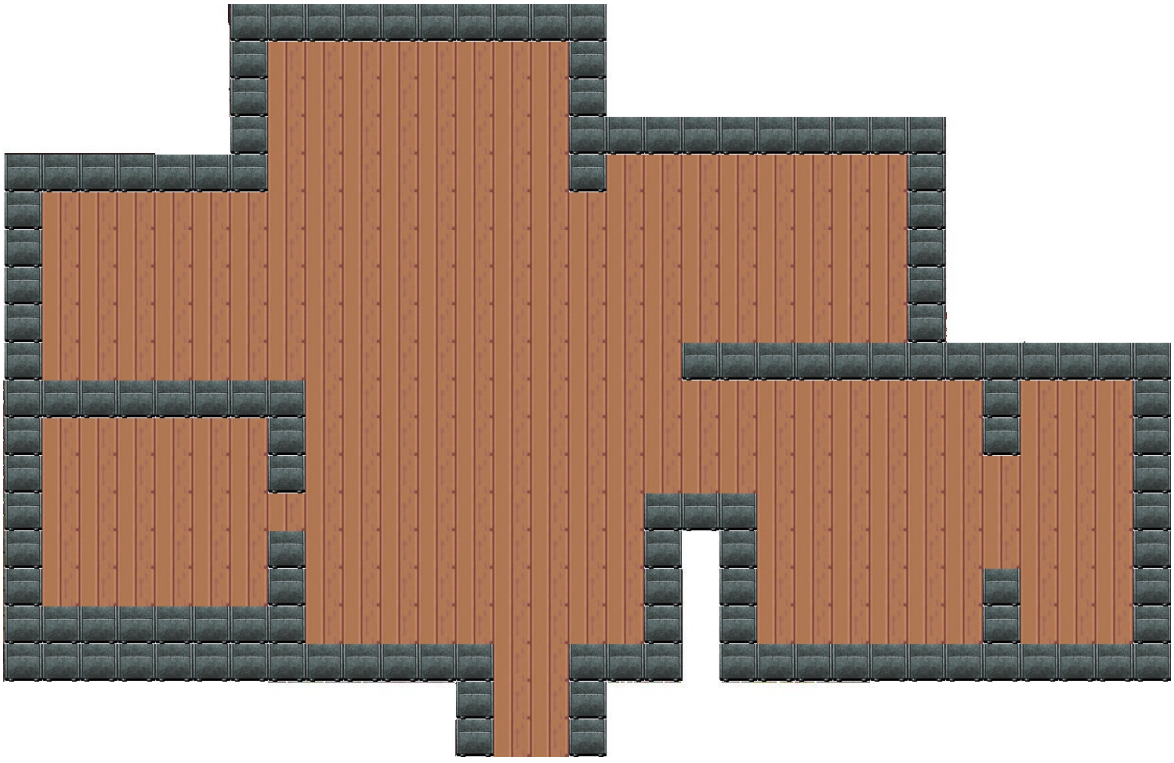
Virtual Prototyping

An Idea

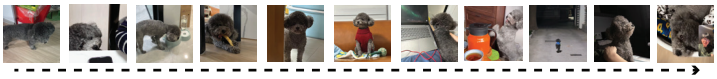
Map Building

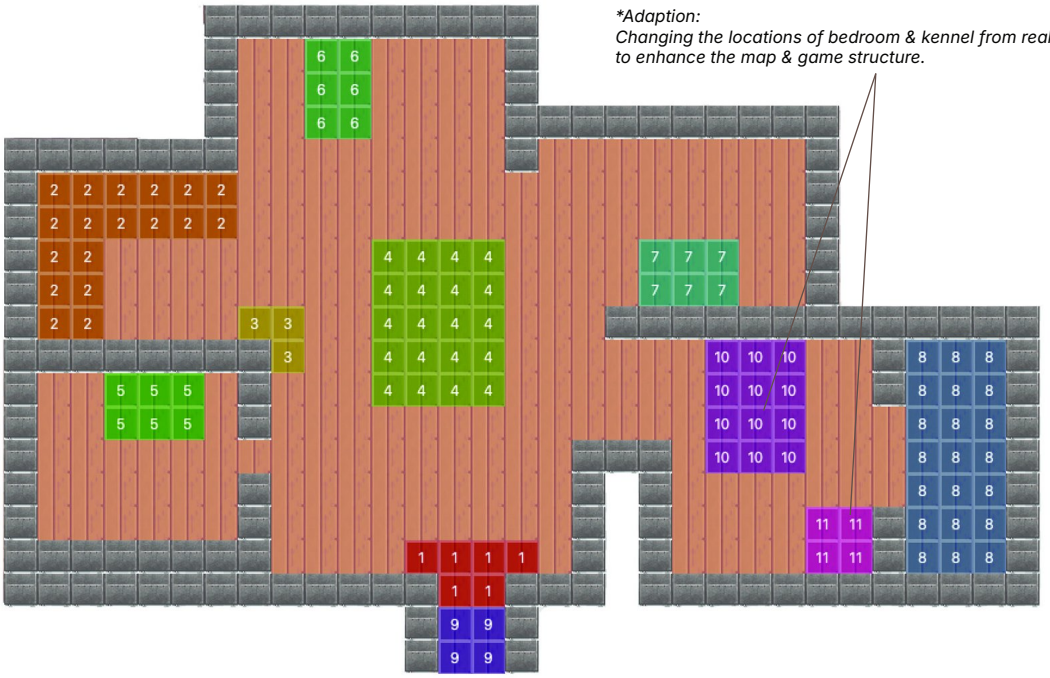


Step 1: Basic Construction



Step 2: Map Activities



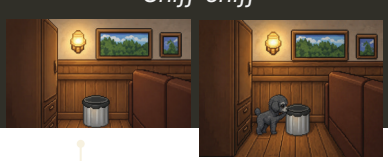


Step 3: Proaram & Hiahliaht the 'Benefit' Games



Step 4: Gameplay &*Fei*-PC *(in-plan)*

Sniff-sniff



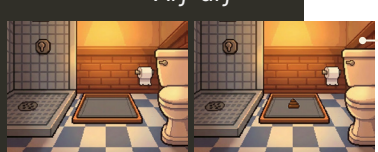
Yip-yip





Yap-yap (Benefit)

Arf-arf







*Huff-huff**

Interact with different activities in a 3 in-game days with highlighted areas.
Game operations (Messages) the players may have:



Ruff-ruff	***Yip-yip***	***Yap-yap***	***Mmm-hmm***	***Arf-a***
Meeting Fei right after stepping through the door. But maybe, after a few days... he changes?	*The troublemaker is here! Try your very best to keep that pot dog-free!*	*Alright, he's hungry too. It's fair to ask him to do some tricks before treats.*	*Time for a good meal myself.*	*It is alw smelly.. It is als good w to obse someth*

Game link: (Welcome for feedback)
https://oliver-yrd.itch.io/fei

*Duh-duh**

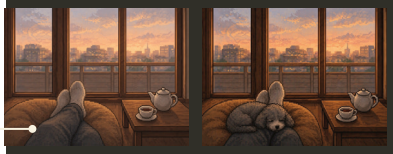




Mmm-hmm



Phew-phew



Whine-whine (Benefit)*



Zzz (Benefit)*



**: AI-genrated game graphics*

rf	***Duh-duh****	***Sniff-sniff***	***Huff-huff****	***Phew-phew***	***Whine-whine****	***Zzz****
ways .. o a ay rve ing.	*Come here~ Let's watch it together. [Are you asleep?]*	*Hey! Hey!*	*Whoa, slow down! Come here! Sorry about that... You can't eat this!*	*It's so great to have my dog with me while playing games !*	*On a sun-drenched afternoon, lying on the beanbag with him... it's a quiet slice of happiness.*	*Each day ends with the quiet, peaceful promise of a better tomorrow.*

Problems!

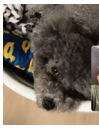
NOW the game wants them to ...
BUT what I wanted them to ...

Feel the Benefits
Feel the Benefits and Costs



Now:



Enter

And it should be fine to have the bad experience at the end!

Users should be allowed to choose what they would like to experience.

It somewhere also changes Fei's behaviors. [Players just would like to feed, play with Fei]

Does enjoying all the benefits at first mean the ultimate experience will be better [in long term]? No!

! *Interact with different activities in a 3 in-game days with **clear highlighted areas**.*

! ***Only 3 of 'benefits'?***

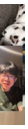
What I want users to experience is that owning a dog is different from what they imagine.
But now it turns to "owning a dog must be a great experience."

More guided like Linear RPG
More free like Open world RPG

Changing their experience
Building their experience

[Adapated]





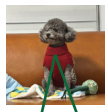
Leave

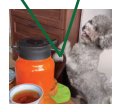
"Oh, it is different from what I thought!"



**Weak guidance*









**User may change his impression at some point*







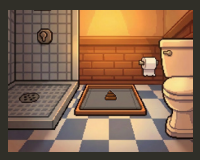
Enter

Leave

Finalized Map

(Add-ons)





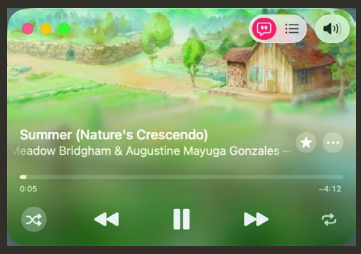
Where experiences are clearly negative, keep providing 'costs'.



(F) : Open & Close highlights

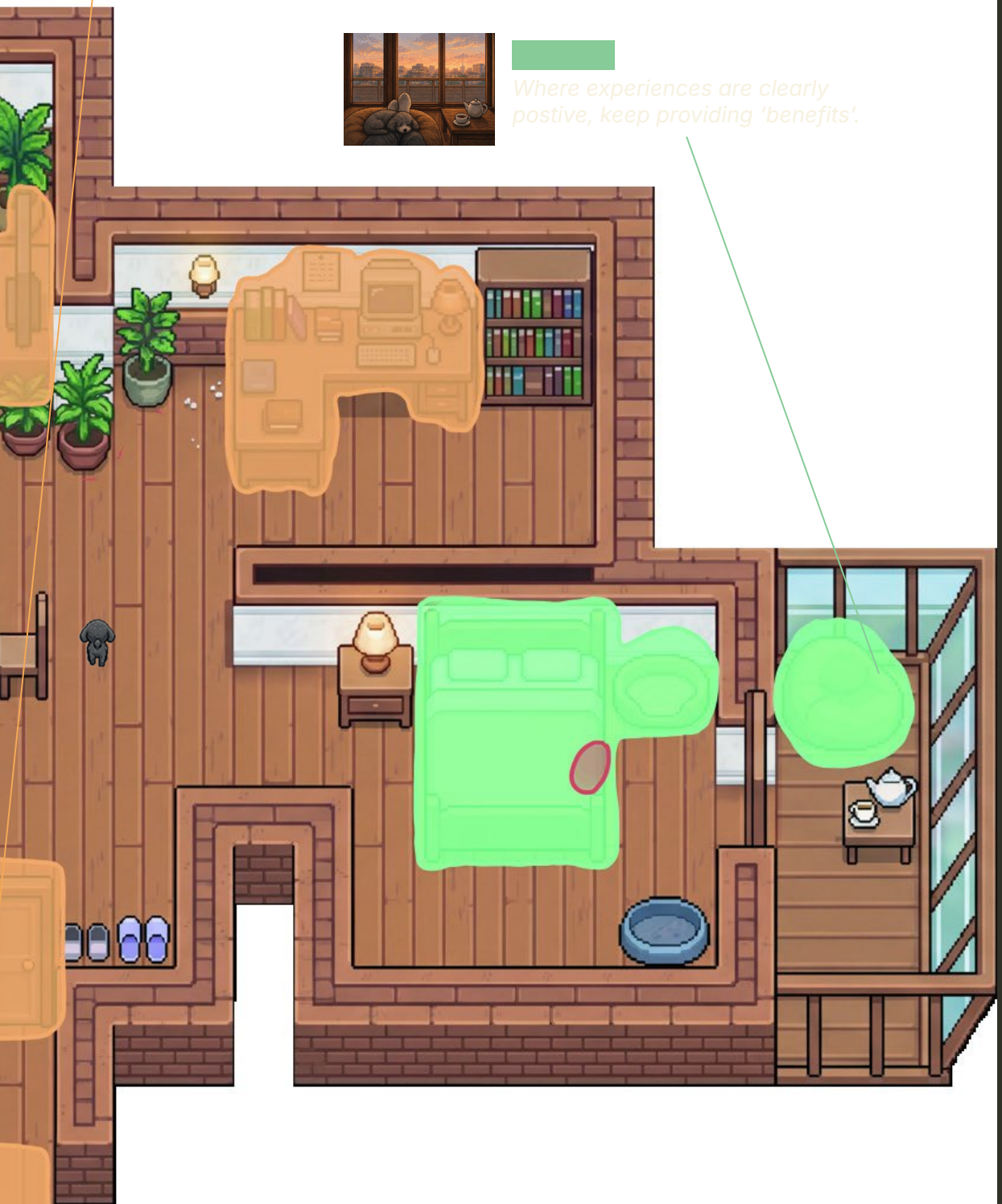


An unknown space.
The experience here may change
from negative to positive during the gameplay.



Peaceful BGMs

Where experiences are clearly
postive, keep providing 'benefits'.





What are their stories?



Tests & Reflections





Lorry:

→ He is a huge animal lover (currently has a little turtle), but he hasn't had the right opportunity to raise a dog of his own yet.

→ His initial impression of Fei after seeing photos: "He's so cute."

→ He is skilled in programming and is an excellent game tester.

His f

→ "Thro

→ "I fee people

→ "The there's



eedback:

ough the testing process, I was able to pick up some of Oliver's knowledge on how to raise a dog."

I like I've gotten to know Fei a little better. I think the [in-game] Fei is someone who warms up to very quickly; he's very proactive in reaching out to me."

interactions in the game are quite simple, making it very relaxing to play. However, I still think a difference between this and interacting with a dog in real life."





Sylvia:

→ She is very afraid of dogs and usually goes out of her way to avoid them on the street.

→ Her initial impression of Fei was simply "he's fat," though she has never met him in person.

→ My Expectation: That she might understand dogs better through this experience and perhaps begin to dissolve her fear.

Her fe

→ "Fei rea

→ "It turns

→ "He's so

→ "The go
if I had the



edback:

lly does eat a lot!"

s out eating a lot means pooping a lot 💩"

o fierce..." [Day 1] → "Wow, he's grown to like me!" [Day 2]

ame didn't make me stop being afraid of dogs in general, but I don't think I'd be afraid of Fei e chance to meet him next time."





My mum:

→ She has spent a long time with Fei, just like I have. I wanted to see if this experience could change anything for a user who already has her own established "service blueprint" (routine) with Fei.

→ When Fei performs the same action, her "interpretation" of his behavior is sometimes slightly different from mine.

→ She is a devoted dog lover.

Her

→ "Wh

→ "I d



feedback:

hat does that [action] mean?"

on't think this part feels like the real Fei at all."

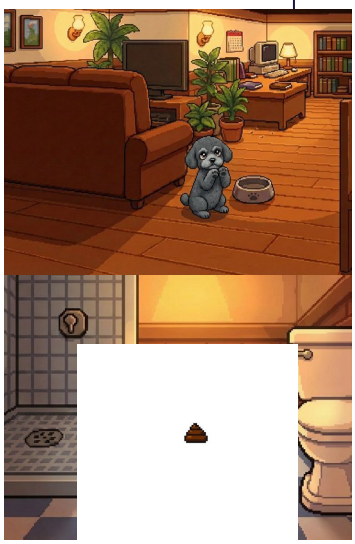
Call [Fei] and Waiting [5s] with BGMs

Click [Fei] to keep him away

Click [button]/[item] to interact [events]







Comfortable, peaceful



In-game

(Reflection #1)

mediums

a means of communication

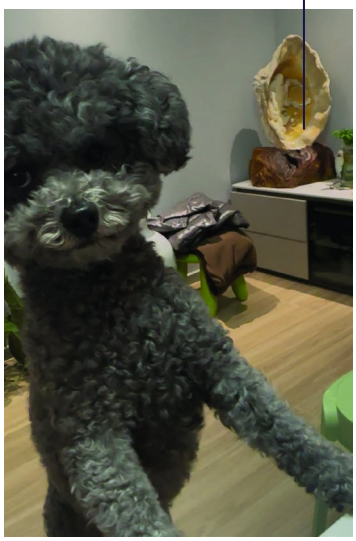
For those familiar w
This virtual prototyp
the authentic essen

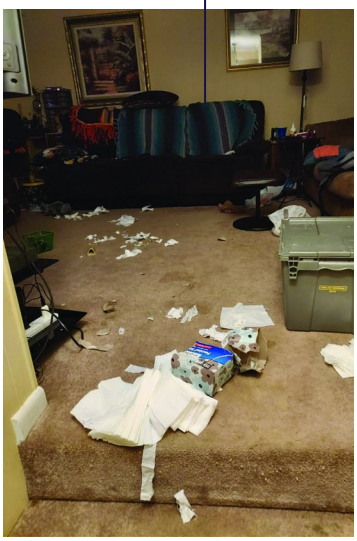
For those unfamilia
The experience also
to grasp.

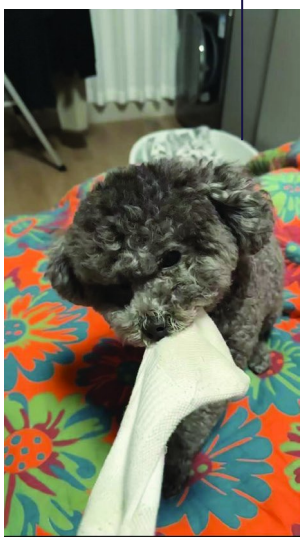
Call [Fei] and 'Beat' him [5s] without BGMs

Click [bowl] to interact a tall [Fei] stand by

'Fight' with [Fei] but hard to win!









Unpredictable

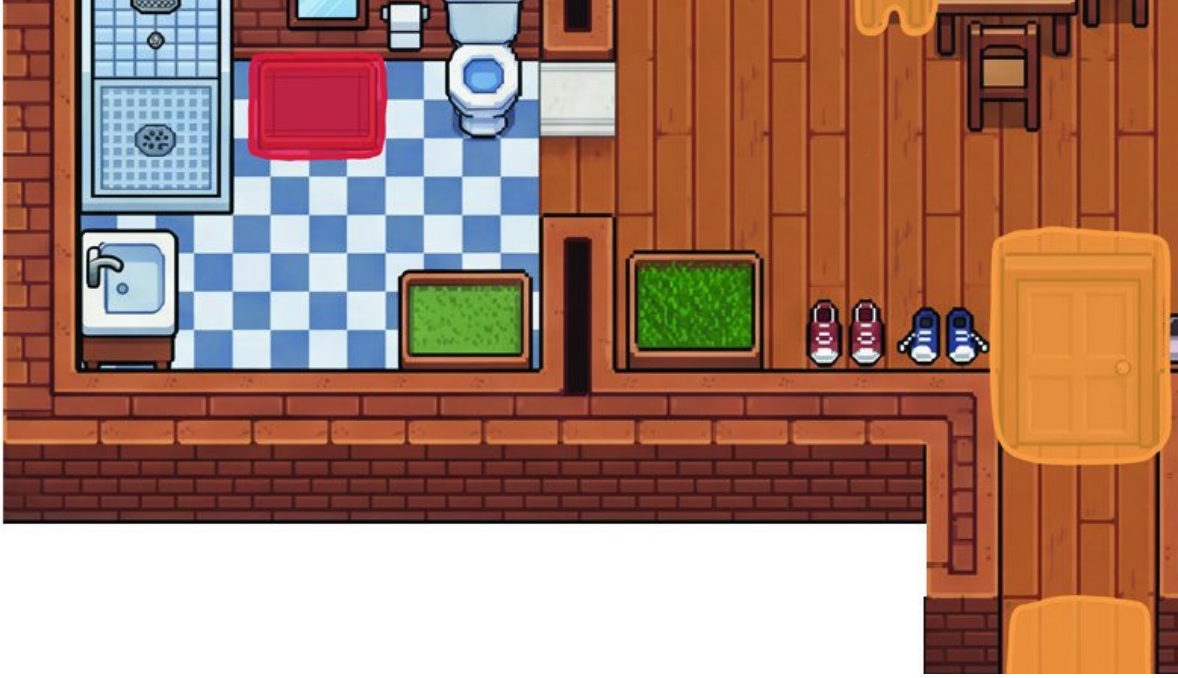
In-reality

with gaming (Lorry, Sylvia):

be lacked a deep sense of immersion because of the gameplay; it couldn't quite capture ce or behavior of a real dog from real-world scenarios to virtual medium.

r with games (Mama):

o lacked immersion, as the gameplay mechanics themselves felt unintuitive or difficult



Stay



(Reflection #2)

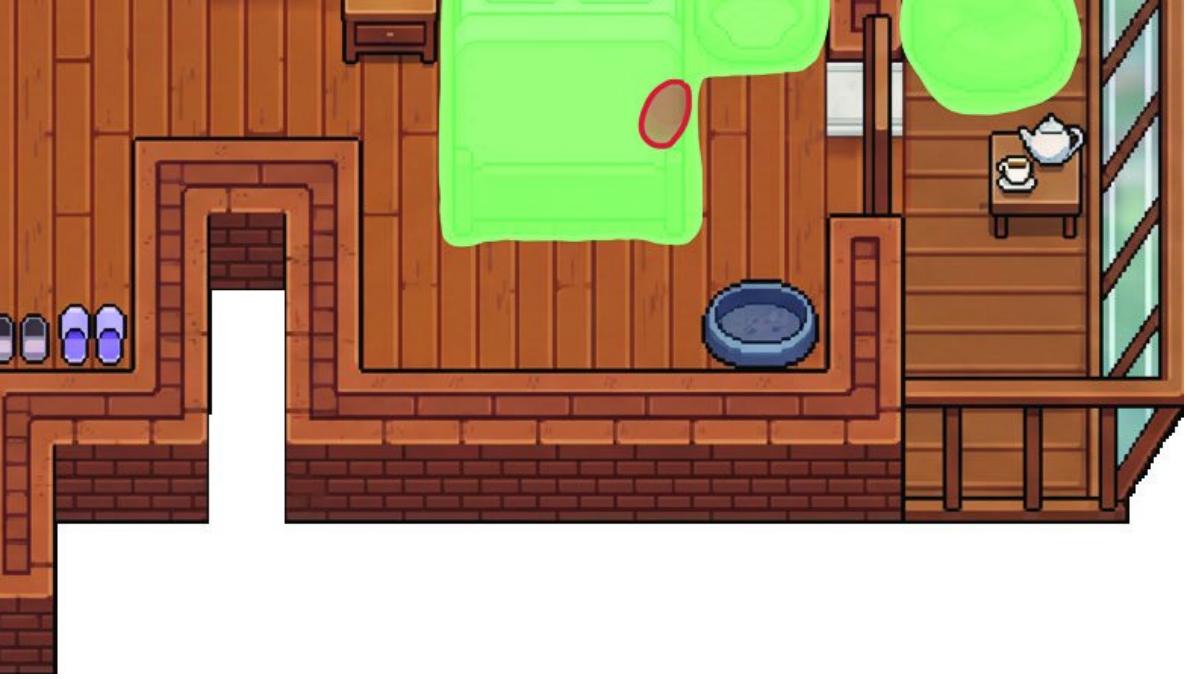
reality

the state of things as they actually exist,
rather than as they may appear, be imagined, or be dreamt.

Does changing user
that I have previously

Current path:
User gains an unders

***If "Unchange":** It me*
Since the user has a
closing the 'door' on



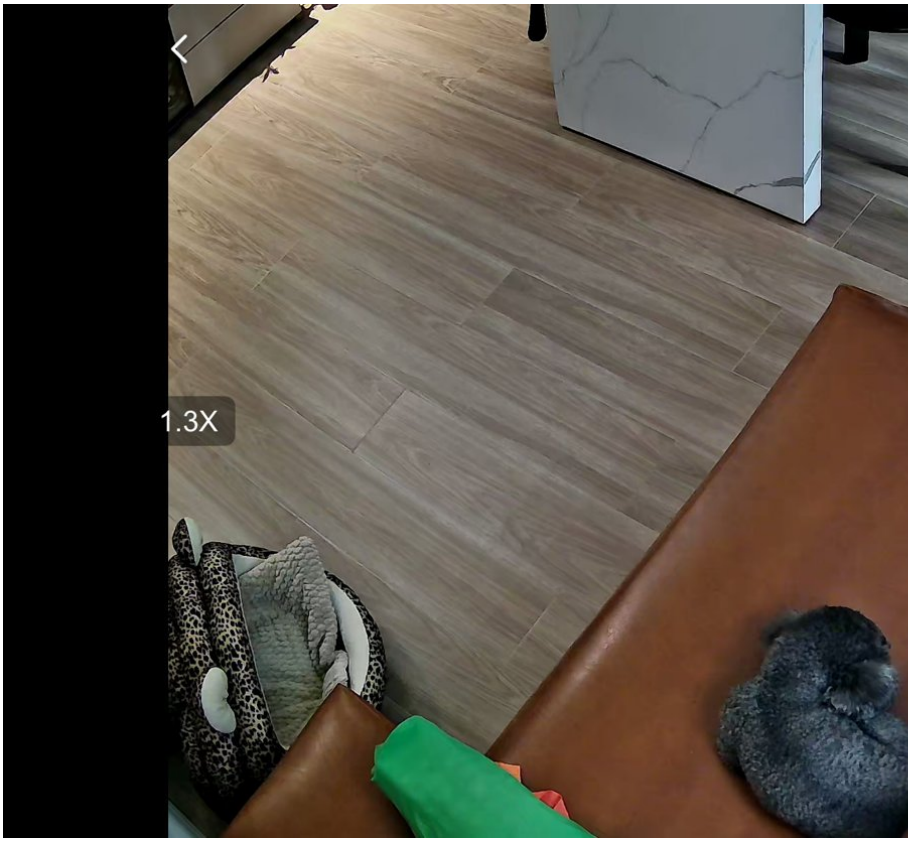
Quit



behavior truly lead to a more satisfying experience from Fei? I feel this is a core contradiction y overlooked.

standing of Fei → "Good or bad" new experience → "Change or Unchange" their old experience.

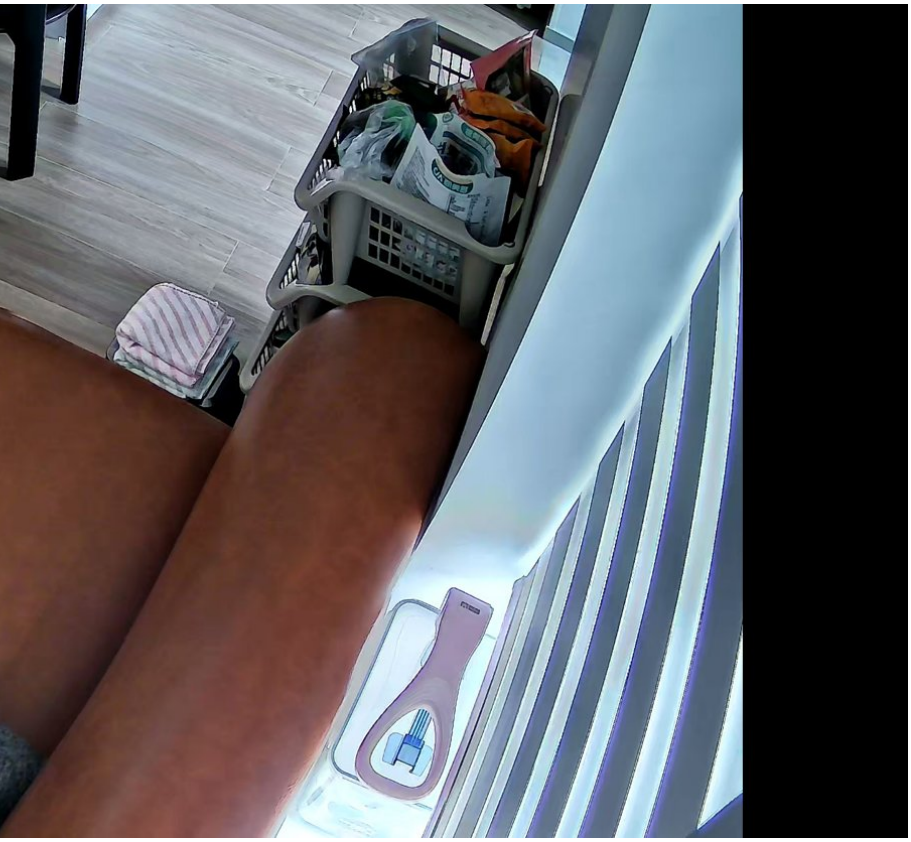
eans Fei failed to provide a satisfying service. More importantly, it creates a dead end. lready experienced the service once and walked away, they are unlikely to ever return, effectively any future interactions.



Yet, looking back at the heart of this journey,
Dogs have always been our bes

Now that I live away from my hometown, I've
In that house, he has become

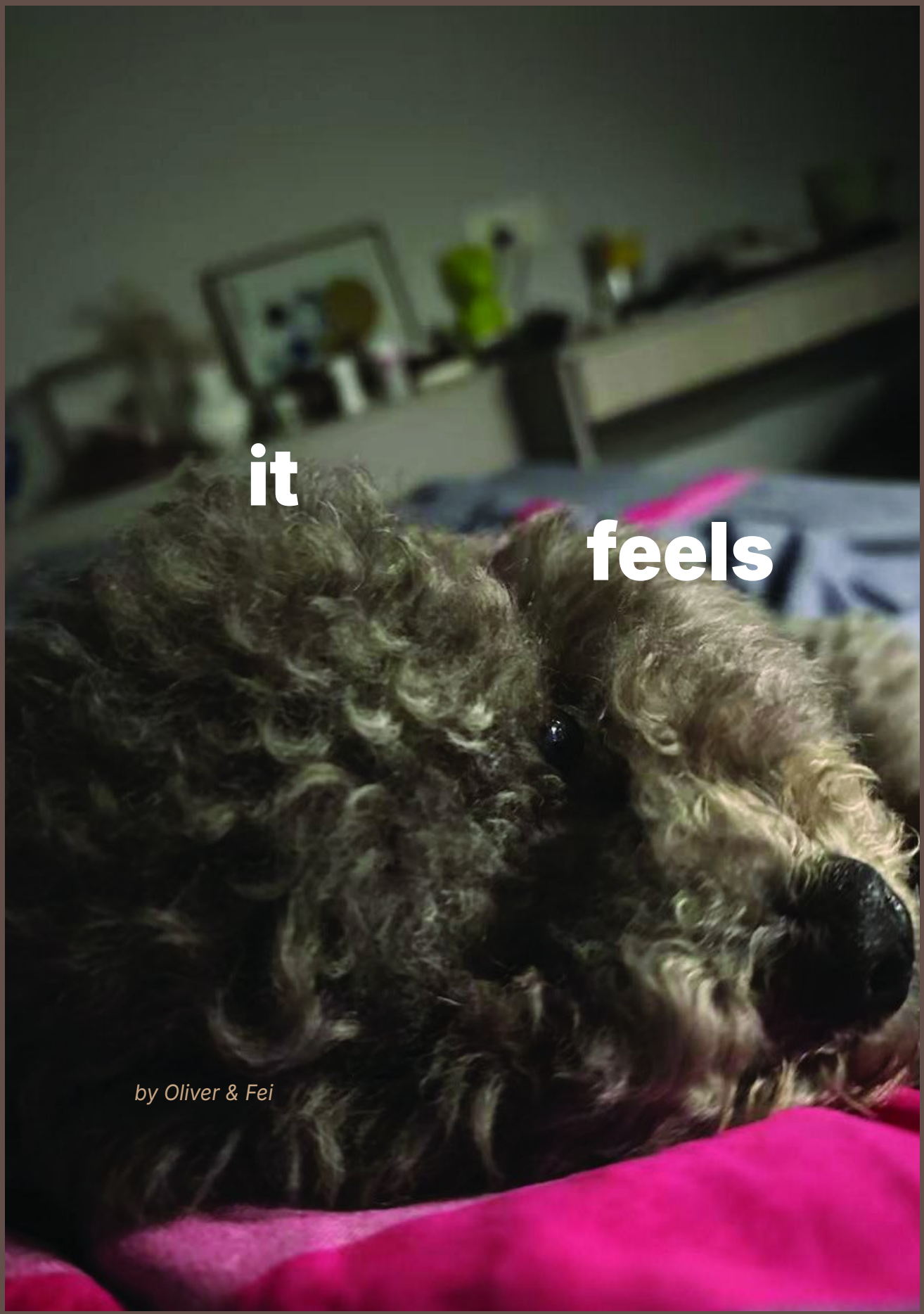
So I believe that as social/service designers, we have the powe



*my deepest wish is simply for others to **feel "it"**.*
st friends, and for me, Fei is the one.

e noticed that Fei is becoming less and less "felt".
the one waiting, but not expressing.

er to make "he feels, she feels, they feels", and we can also make ...


it
feels
by Oliver & Fei